

Session 2

Concept and Requirements

Using NotebookLM to build the first draft of the technical and visual/commercial reports

Specification of Products and Services

Robust Design

Today's goal

Move from the Session 1 index to a usable report section.

Input from Session 1

Index of the technical report + idea for the visual/commercial report.

NotebookLM work

Use uploaded sources to generate a structured draft with text and suggested images.

Output for Session 2

Concept and Requirements report: overview, value proposition and requirements.

Reports check

The report must support both future deliverables: production and user-facing communication.



What previous reports show us

Good technical reports begin with concept and requirements before moving into production.

Concept

Product idea, user, context, problem and value proposition.

Requirements

What the product must do, how it should perform and how it will be checked.

Specification

Materials, parts, dimensions, drawings, BOM, processes, ergonomics and validation.

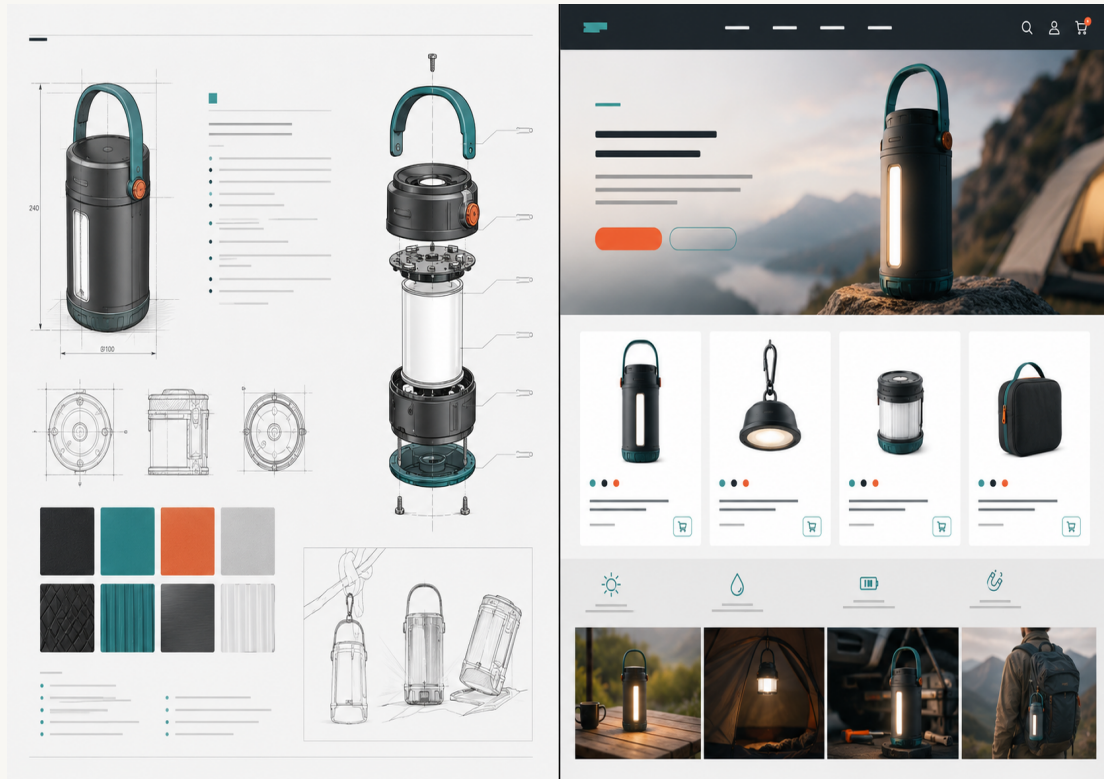
Session 2 focuses only on the first two levels.

- Do not write the final production manual yet.
- Do define what the product needs to prove later.
- Do connect technical criteria with how the product will be shown to users.

Concept → Requirements → Evidence

Two reports, one foundation

The Session 2 report must support both paths.



Technical report

For a manufacturer. It explains what the product is, what it includes, what it must do and what information will be needed for production.

Visual / commercial report

For the final user. It explains how the product should be shown, understood, desired and purchased.

Same product. Different purpose. Different language.

Session 2 report structure

Can use this as the base for their PDF, Google Doc, Notion page or NotebookLM prompt.

Section	What it must include
1. Overview	What the product is, who it is for and what problem it solves.
2. User + context	Target user, situation of use, needs and pain points.
3. Problem statement	Clear statement of the main problem in 3–5 lines.
4. Value proposition	Why the product is useful, different and desirable.
5. Concept direction	Moodboard, design intention, product personality and key attributes.
6. Technical direction	Materials, parts, mechanisms, dimensions, production, assembly, safety, ergonomics and maintenance.
7. Visual / commercial direction	Website, shopping page, app, configurator, videos, renders, benefits and purchase experience.
8. Requirements table	Requirements with category, criteria, visual translation and evidence needed.
9. MVP + next steps	What the first functional version must prove and what must be researched next.

NotebookLM workflow

NotebookLM can write the first draft, but the team must edit, verify and complete it.

01

Upload sources

Session 1 index, sketches, brief, moodboard, renders, feedback, benchmarks.

02

Upload visuals

Create a visual evidence PDF or slides with numbered images and captions.

03

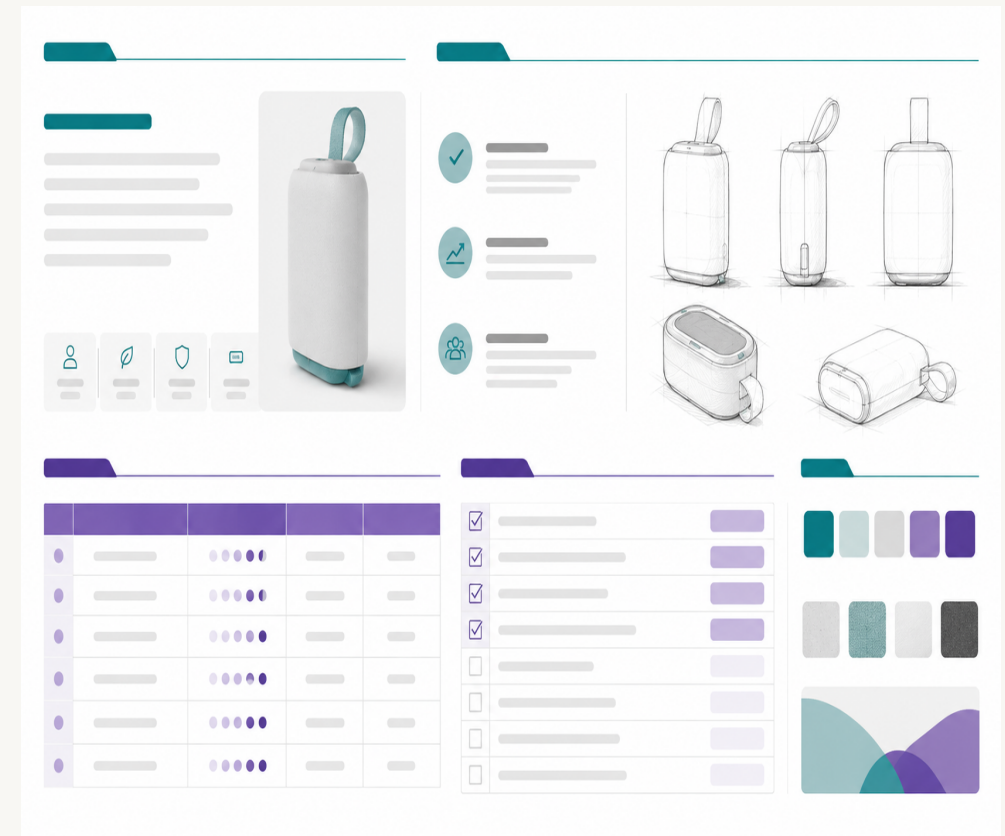
Prompt NotebookLM

Ask for the Session 2 report using only the uploaded sources.

04

Edit and layout

Move the text and images into Docs, Notion, Canva or PDF format.



Before prompting: prepare visual evidence

NotebookLM works better when the images are organized and labeled.

Figure	Image type	Caption example	Report section
Fig. 1	Main render or sketch	Product overview and main function	Overview
Fig. 2	User/context image	Where and how the product is used	User + context
Fig. 3	Moodboard	Visual language and product personality	Concept direction
Fig. 4	Parts diagram	Early technical logic of the product	Technical direction
Fig. 5	Website / app mockup	How the product could be shown or sold	Visual / commercial direction
Fig. 6	Prototype photo	What the first MVP should prove	MVP

Tip: do not upload loose images without names. Put them in one visual evidence file.

Prompt for NotebookLM

Paste this and adapt the project name.

Using only the sources uploaded to this notebook, create a Session 2 report titled “Concept and Requirements”.

Base the report on the index we created in Session 1.

The report must include:

1. Project Overview
2. User and Context
3. Problem Statement
4. Value Proposition
5. Concept Direction
6. Technical Direction for the manufacturer report
7. Visual / Commercial Direction for the user-facing report
8. Requirements Table
9. MVP Definition
10. Missing Information
11. Next Steps

The requirements table must include:

Requirement, Category, Why is it important?, Technical success criteria, Visual / commercial translation, and Evidence needed.

Do not invent information. If something is missing, write “to be defined” or “needs evidence”.

Requirements table: what each row needs

This is the main evidence of Session 2.

Column	What students should write
Requirement	What the product must do or communicate.
Category	User, functional, technical, ergonomic, production, safety, sustainability or market.
Why it matters	Why this requirement is important for the user, product or context.
Technical success criteria	How it will be checked later: size, weight, time, load, resistance, comfort, etc.
Visual / commercial translation	How this requirement should be shown to the final user.
Evidence needed	What proof must be created: photos, tests, dimensions, diagrams, renders, mockups or references.

Minimum: 12–15 requirements per team

Include user, functional, technical, ergonomic, production, safety, sustainability and market/communication requirements.

Report checklist

Section	What it should include	Checklist
1. Cover / Header	Project name, team members, course name, session number and date.	Project name. Team members. Course name. Session 2. Date. Main image, sketch or render.
2. Project Overview	A short explanation of what the product is.	What the product is. Who it is for. What problem it solves. Where or when it is used.
3. User and Context	Description of the main user and use situation.	Target user. Approximate age or profile. User activities. Use context. Main user needs.
4. Problem Statement	Clear explanation of the main problem.	Clear problem. Current situation. Why the problem matters. Main difficulty or friction.
5. Value Proposition	Explanation of why the product is valuable, different and desirable.	Main benefit. Difference from existing products. Why the user would use it. Why the user would buy it.
6. Concept Direction	Design intention, visual references and product personality.	Main concept idea. Moodboard or references. Initial color palette. Product attributes. Visual tone.
7. Technical Direction	Direction for the future manufacturer report.	Possible materials. Main parts. Mechanisms or connections. Dimensions to define. Possible production processes. Assembly logic. Maintenance. Safety considerations.
8. Visual / Commercial Direction	Direction for the future user-facing report.	Type of visual deliverable: website, landing page, shopping page, app or configurator. Images needed. Main benefits to communicate. How product use will be explained. How purchase or customization will be shown.
9. Requirements Table	Main table of product requirements.	User requirements. Functional requirements. Technical requirements. Ergonomic requirements. Production requirements. Safety requirements. Sustainability requirements. Market / communication requirements.
10. Success Criteria	How each requirement will be checked.	Each requirement has a way to be verified. Includes measurable or observable criteria such as size, weight, resistance, comfort, time, ease of use or expected test.
11. Evidence Needed	Evidence that will be created in later sessions.	Photos. Sketches. Renders. Diagrams. Tests. Measurements. Material references. Benchmarks. User feedback.
12. MVP Definition	What the first functional version must include.	Main function. What the MVP includes. What the MVP does not include yet. What will be tested first.
13. Missing Information	Information the team still needs to find, define or test.	Missing dimensions. Materials to confirm. Processes to research. Costs to estimate. Tests to design. Missing images or diagrams.
14. Next Steps	Concrete actions before the next session.	5 to 7 clear actions. What to research. What to draw. What to measure. What to test. What image, render or diagram to prepare.

Example: one requirement row

Use this level of clarity; avoid vague words like “nice”, “cool” or “resistant” without proof.

Requirement	Category	Why it matters	Success criteria	Visual translation	Evidence
The product must remain stable during movement.	Technical / user	The user will move while carrying, wearing or attaching the product.	It does not detach, block movement or move excessively during a basic movement test.	Show the product in real use: walking, skating, biking, commuting or outdoor activity.	Video test, photos, feedback.

Weak requirement

“The product should be resistant.”

Better requirement

“The module must resist X weight or X movement test without detaching.”

Best next step

Define what X is and what evidence will prove it.

What images should support the report?

Each image should prove or explain something. Do not use images only as decoration.



Product image

Best render, sketch or prototype photo for the overview.

User context

Photo, collage or scenario showing where the product is used.

Concept direction

Moodboard, material references, color palette and design attributes.

Technical direction

Parts sketch, exploded view, mechanism diagram or material references.

Visual report

Website, shopping page, app or configurator mockup.

Label images as Figure 1, Figure 2, etc. and write a short caption.

Session 2 submission checklist

The report must show direction, criteria and evidence plan — not final production content yet.

- Overview: clear in 3–5 lines.
- User and context: specific, not generic.
- Value proposition: useful + different + desirable.
- Technical direction: what the manufacturer report will need later.
- Visual/commercial direction: how the user will understand and want the product.
- Requirements table: 12–15 rows with success criteria and evidence needed.
- MVP: what the first version must prove.
- Missing information + next steps: honest and specific.

The Session 2 report must have **8 to 12 pages**, including text, tables and visual references.
The report should not exceed **15 pages**.

Final output

Concept and
Requirements Report

PDF / Notion / Google Doc / Canva

Use NotebookLM, but edit your final text